Project Report

Young Women Skills Training Program

Field	Details
Reference	ADA/2023/002
Organization	Apoti Development Association (ADA)
Period	April 1 – October 31, 2023
Location	Yaoundé, Centre Region, Cameroon
Report Date	November 2023

---

1. Executive Summary

The Young Women Skills Training Program successfully trained 10 young women in hairdressing and tailoring over a 6-month intensive program in Yaoundé. This was ADA's first project outside its established areas of Buea and Bamenda. All 10 participants graduated, with 8 now earning income from their acquired skills and 2 having opened their own businesses. The project was delivered under budget at 1,150,000 CFA ($1,917) against a budget of 1,200,000 CFA ($2,000).

2. Background & Context

ADA identified a group of young women in Yaoundé aged 18–30 who had completed secondary school but could not afford university. These women were living with relatives on temporary arrangements and lacked marketable skills for economic independence. The program was designed to provide them with practical vocational training and the support needed to transition into income-generating activities.

3. Activities Implemented

3.1 Beneficiary Selection (April 2023)

- 10 young women identified and enrolled
- All met selection criteria: secondary school graduates, aged 18–30, no marketable skills, living in temporary arrangements

3.2 Vocational Training (April – September 2023)

- **Hairdressing track**: Braiding, weaving, styling, chemical treatments, salon management
- **Tailoring track**: Pattern cutting, machine operation, garment construction, alterations, fabric selection
- Training delivered 5 days per week by 2 qualified instructors
- All materials provided (fabric, hair products, tools, equipment)

3.3 Business Skills Module (August – September 2023)

- Pricing and costing
- Customer service
- Basic bookkeeping
- Marketing and client acquisition

- Business registration basics

3.4 Stipend Disbursement (April – September 2023)

- Monthly stipend of 8,000 CFA paid to each participant
- Enabled participants to cover transport and basic needs during training
- 100% disbursement rate across all 6 months

3.5 Graduation & Starter Kits (October 2023)

- Graduation ceremony held for all 10 participants
- Each graduate received a starter kit valued at 10,000 CFA containing essential tools for their trade

4. Results & Outcomes

Indicator	Target	Achieved
Women enrolled	10	10
Women graduated	10	10 (100%)
Graduates earning income	8 (80%)	8 (80%)
Graduates who opened businesses	—	2
Months of training delivered	6	6
Stipend months disbursed	60 (total)	60 (100%)

5. Key Achievements

- **100% completion rate**: All 10 enrolled women completed the full 6-month program
- **80% income generation**: 8 of 10 graduates are now earning income from their skills
- **Entrepreneurship**: 2 graduates opened their own businesses
- **Geographic expansion**: Successfully established ADA's first project in Yaoundé
- **Under-budget delivery**: Project completed at 1,150,000 CFA, saving 50,000 CFA

6. Challenges & Lessons Learned

Challenge	Response
First project in new city — no established networks	Leveraged church and community connections for beneficiary identification
Participants needed transport support	Monthly stipend covered basic transport and living costs
Balancing two vocational tracks with limited instructors	Structured timetable with alternating practical sessions

Lessons Learned

- Monthly stipends are essential for retention in full-time training programs
- Starter kits significantly accelerate post-graduation income generation
- Business skills training should be integrated throughout, not only at the end
- ADA's model is replicable in new geographic areas with proper coordination

7. Sustainability

- Graduates are generating their own income and no longer dependent on relatives
- 2 graduates have established businesses that may employ others in future
- Skills acquired are permanent and transferable
- ADA now has operational knowledge and contacts in Yaoundé for future programs

8. Financial Summary

Item	Budget (CFA)	Actual (CFA)
Total	1,200,000	1,150,000
Variance		**50,000 underspend**
USD Equivalent	$2,000	$1,917

Full financial breakdown available in the accompanying Financial Report.

9. Recommendations

1. Scale the program to serve more women in subsequent cohorts
2. Integrate business skills training from month 1 rather than the final months
3. Establish a follow-up mentorship program for graduates
4. Explore partnerships with local salons and tailoring shops for apprenticeship placements
5. Consider adding a micro-loan component for graduates starting businesses

10. Conclusion

The Young Women Skills Training Program achieved all its primary objectives. Ten vulnerable young women now possess marketable vocational skills and the majority are already earning income. The project demonstrated that ADA's community empowerment model works effectively in new geographic areas and that relatively modest investments ($2,000) can transform lives when well-targeted and well-managed.

Prepared by: Apoti Development Association (ADA) Report Date: November 2023